



ICE WARS

What It Is

Ice Wars looks like a side scrolling action game at first glance. However, it's a lot different from being an action game. Set somewhere in the Arctic Circle, *Ice Wars* is a turn based strategy game where your goal is to eliminate all players of the opposing team using a large variety of weapons. The game's setting reminds you of *Worms Armageddon*, but there's the added feature of letting you choose your players from 3 different classes, each with its own strengths and attack stats along with special attacks. As you play the game, you will realise it's a lot more than just aim, shoot and end turn. You will often end up stuck deciding on

what weapon to choose for maximum damage. Even the maps are strategically designed; everything you read in Sun Tzu's *Art of War* will come into play when playing this.

Why It's Addictive

A single game of *Ice Wars* could stretch for up to an hour. The number of ways to take out your enemies is tremendous, with the huge array of weapons at your disposal. You are limited to the amount of moves you make in a single turn, requiring you to carefully calculate your moves before making them. Adding to the fun is the fact that you can play multiplayer with your friends with game modes like Last Man Standing and Capture The Flag. The replay feature is something you will often find yourself using after you have just



whacked four enemies with a single shot. For this game to truly shine it has to be played in multiplayer, and believe us when we tell you that you will never go back to chess after this!



COUNTER-STRIKE 2D

What It Is

Counter-Strike (CS), originally nothing more than a mod for the legendary *Half-Life*, is still the most played multiplayer game, even now—almost ten years after the game was released. If your PC is something that would soon make its way into a museum showcase, or if you still can't convince your dad to shell out around Rs 1,000 for a computer game, there's an answer for you—*Counter-Strike 2D*. Almost everything in the game is the same as *Counter-Strike*, except for one major change—it's 2D. You have a top view of your player and control him along the map.

You can play as terrorists or counter-terrorists, and your objective is either to plant the bomb as the terrorists or to defuse it as the counter-terrorists. You can also have different objectives like rescuing hostages.

Why It's Addictive

Counter-Strike 2D is a mini-CS at heart, and shares its big brother's addictiveness.

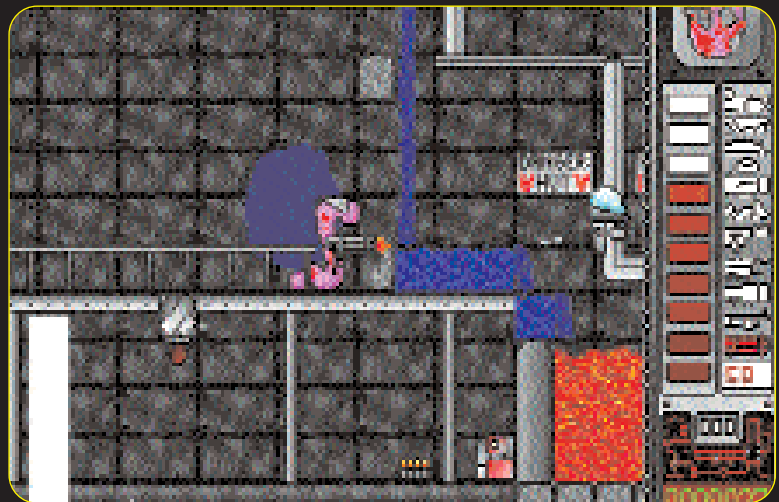
Though it's primarily a multiplayer game, you can also play with bots. In multiplayer, the game truly shines; you can play with teams on the same maps for CS, including *de_aztec*, *de_dust*, etc., except in 2D action. The large amount of maps included with CS2D adds to the replay value of the game. Not enough? Well, there's also the fact that there's a simple to use map editor included within the game itself to keep you busy for quite a few hours. Even heavy console and cfg-tweakers (that's configuration file tweakers) will be satisfied with the vast amount of commands and variables offered with this game, most of which are similar to the original *Counter-Strike*. Well, actually we could have probably just written the review in a few words: it's 2D, but it's still CS!



5. WORMINATOR

What It Is

Like the name suggests, the story of *Worminator* is similar to the ever-popular *Terminator*. However, instead of the good of worm-kind, you fight for the Worminators, who are fighting a losing battle against the rebels led by Wrom Conner. You are a prototype Worm-borg, just created at one of the factories controlled by Dirtnet, the leader of Worminators. No one knows exactly who, or what Dirtnet is. You must escape the factory surrounded by the Worman rebels; you are now the Worminators' last hope.



The story is unique and funny to the core, but that's not all. *Worminator* is a side scrolling action game that allows you to choose from up to 12 unique weapons, and 12 kinds of enemies to test them out on. There are also small nifty features like your character changing its appearance as it takes damage (*a la Wolf 3D*) and skin support for the interface.

Why It's Addictive

Like RPGs, side-scrolling games never fail to grab our undivided attention and *Worminator* does so perfectly. The main campaign itself is lengthy and tough enough to keep you occupied for days. Even if you do manage to finish it, you will want to play it again and again. If you do get bored, which is rare, you can always make your own levels with the integrated editor. The 12 weapons, including the BFG (yup! ou heard us), keep your experience fresh and varied. This is one of the few games which will keep you addicted despite lacking a multiplayer mode.